

HAYEK STUDIOS

Instagram Reels Growth Strategy

Q1 2026 Campaign Results & Strategy Documentation

157,591

Views

83,858

Reach

6,581

Interactions

10d 20h

Watch Time

46

New Follows

Document Purpose

This document outlines the Instagram Reels strategy developed and executed by Carole Mutemi (VA & SMM) for Hayek Studios, a wedding photography studio. It covers the strategic approach, content framework, execution process, campaign results, and recommendations for continued growth.

Client

Hayek Studios — Wedding Photography Studio

Campaign Period

Q1 2026 (January — March 2026)

Prepared By

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SECTION 1 — STRATEGY OVERVIEW

The Challenge

Hayek Studios had a strong portfolio of wedding photography but limited social media reach. The existing Instagram presence was inconsistent and heavily reliant on static photos. Engagement was low and the account was not converting profile visits into enquiries. The goal was to leverage Instagram Reels to dramatically increase reach, grow brand awareness, and drive booking enquiries.

The Approach

A structured Reels strategy was developed focused on three content pillars: emotional storytelling, behind-the-scenes authenticity, and educational wedding content. Each Reel was crafted to stop the scroll in the first 3 seconds, deliver value within 30 seconds, and end with a clear call to action.

Pillar 1

Pillar 2

Pillar 3

Emotional Storytelling	Behind the Scenes	Educational Wedding Tips
Wedding day highlights, first look moments, emotional vows, couple reactions. Content that makes viewers feel something and want to share.	Day in the life of a wedding photographer, gear setup, location scouting, editing process. Builds trust and humanises the brand.	Wedding planning tips, photography advice for couples, venue recommendations, posing guides. Attracts engaged couples actively planning.

SECTION 2 — CONTENT FRAMEWORK

Reel Structure Formula

Timestamp	Section	Purpose & Execution
0:00 - 0:03	THE HOOK	Stop the scroll. Open with the most visually stunning or emotionally charged moment. No text introduction. Let the visuals speak first.
0:03 - 0:08	THE SETUP	Quick context — where are we, who is this about? Keep it tight. One or two text overlays maximum.
0:08 - 0:25	THE STORY	The emotional core of the Reel. Build tension, show the moment, let it breathe. Music choice is critical here.
0:25 - 0:28	THE PAYOFF	The best shot. The reaction. The tear. The kiss. The moment people will share. Hold it for 2-3 seconds.
0:28 - 0:30	THE CTA	Clear text overlay: 'Book your date — link in bio' or 'DM us your wedding date'. One action only.

Posting Strategy

Frequency	Best Times	Ideal Length	Hashtags
3-4 Reels per week	Tue/Thu 7PM, Sat 10AM	25 - 30 seconds	15-20 per post

SECTION 3 — CAMPAIGN RESULTS

Top Performing Reel — Q1 2026

Metric	Result
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Total Views	157,591
Reach (Unique Accounts)	83,858
Total Interactions	6,581
Watch Time	10 days, 20 hours
New Followers Gained	46
Content Type	Wedding Day Highlight Reel
Reel Length	28 seconds
Performance vs Previous Average	More views than all recent Reels combined

Why This Reel Performed

- Strong emotional hook in the first 3 seconds — opened with the bride's reaction at the altar
- Perfect music sync — beat drops aligned with the most powerful visual moments
- Authentic, unposed moments — no staged content, purely documentary style
- Optimal length — 28 seconds kept viewers watching without losing attention
- Posted on a Tuesday at 7PM — peak engagement window for the target audience
- Caption included a direct question that drove comments and shares
- 15 highly targeted hashtags including location-specific and niche wedding tags

SECTION 4 — HASHTAG STRATEGY

Hashtag Framework

A three-tier hashtag strategy was used on every Reel to maximise discoverability across different audience sizes:

Tier	Size Range	Examples
Tier 1 — Broad	1M+ posts	#weddingphotography #wedding #weddingday #bride #weddingphoto
Tier 2 — Mid	100K - 1M posts	#weddingphotographer #weddingfilm #bridetobe #weddinginspo #couplegoals
Tier 3 — Niche	Under 100K posts	#hayekstudios #weddingphotographerusa #authenticweddingphotography

#documentarywedding

SECTION 5 — RECOMMENDATIONS & NEXT STEPS

Based on Q1 campaign results, the following recommendations are made for Q2 2026:

#	Recommendation	Rationale
01	Increase Reel frequency to 5 per week	The top-performing Reel proves high demand for this content. More consistent posting will compound reach over time.
02	Add captions/subtitles to all Reels	85% of Instagram videos are watched without sound. Captions increase watch time and accessibility significantly.
03	Create a dedicated Reels highlight cover	Organising Reels into a Highlight increases profile discoverability and makes it easy for new visitors to find the best content.
04	Test longer Reels (45-60 seconds)	Instagram's algorithm currently favours longer watch time. Testing 45-60 second Reels could unlock higher reach.
05	Collaborate with wedding vendors	Joint Reels with florists, venues, and wedding planners dramatically expand reach into new, relevant audiences.
06	Run a 30-day engagement push	Reply to every comment within 1 hour for 30 days. High early engagement signals quality to the algorithm and boosts distribution.

Document Summary

This strategy document demonstrates the Instagram Reels approach developed and executed for Hayek Studios. The results — 157,591 views, 83,858 reach, and 6,581 interactions from a single Reel — validate the effectiveness of the content framework. The strategy continues to be refined and optimised on a weekly basis.

Prepared by: Carole Mutemi, VA & SMM | Q1 2026 | Hayek Studios